

Sealing



A wax seal, crest pressed in, ribbon hanging, on a written document. The seal says: this is real, this is official, this is not yours to break.

Before you gather

- Read Day 22, Sealing, in The Visual Gospel. Do not reteach the essay.
- Read Ephesians 4:30 and 2 Corinthians 1:21–22 in your Bible. The excerpt below is only a backup.

- Your people should already have answered the day's reflection questions. Do not ask those again.
- Leave with a name. The missional challenge only works if someone is named before you pray.

1 · ICEBREAKER · 7 MIN

Open the room

What paper, key, or mark proves that something is actually yours?

Leader. Proof of ownership. The book already asked how sealing helps them feel safe, and it used Philippians 1:6. Do not repeat those. Say that passing is allowed, especially the first few weeks.

2 · THE WORD · 8 MIN

See it, then say it

IF YOU NEED THE WORDS

Say: A seal is not a decoration. It marks ownership and says the document stands. When a sinner hears the gospel and believes, God seals him with the Holy Spirit. You are not held by your grip. You are marked as His, and He guarantees the end.

DEFINITION, FROM THE BOOK

Sealing is the divine act by which the Holy Spirit marks believers as God's own possession, guarantees their future inheritance, and secures them for salvation.

IN THE ORIGINAL LANGUAGE

Greek sphragizō — to seal, to mark with a sign of ownership and authenticity.

MEMORY VERSE · EPHESIANS 1:13

In him you also, when you heard the word of truth, the gospel of your salvation, and believed in him, were sealed with the promised Holy Spirit.

Together, open the flashcard for Sealing. Say the word, the definition, and the verse once. Then put the phone away.

3 · OPEN THE BIBLE · 15 MIN

Ephesians 4:30 and 2 Corinthians 1:21–22

Ephesians 1:13 is the memory verse: sealed when you heard the word of truth and believed. These two short texts show what the seal means on a bad day. Do not grieve the Spirit who sealed you. God is the One who establishes you. The seal is His guarantee, not your mood.

And do not grieve the Holy Spirit of God, by whom you were sealed for the day of redemption. And it is God who establishes us with you in Christ, and has anointed us, and who has also put his seal on us and given us his Spirit in our hearts as a guarantee.

Have two readers if you can. Bibles open. The excerpt is only here so a forgotten Bible does not stop the night.

From the passage

1. You can grieve the Spirit. According to these verses, can you unseal yourself? What was the seal for? **CORE**

Leader. Grief is real. Sin saddens the Spirit. It does not erase the mark. You were sealed for the day of redemption. Say this clearly: do not tell an unbeliever they are already sealed. The seal follows hearing and believing.

2. Who establishes, anoints, and seals in 2 Corinthians 1? What else is the Spirit called?

Leader. God does it. The Spirit is a guarantee, a down payment of the inheritance. Assurance rests on the Sealer, not on a feeling that comes and goes.

4 · AROUND THE ROOM · 20 MIN

A conversation this chapter did not assign

3. Ephesians 1:13 puts the seal after hearing the gospel and believing. What does that order guard? What does it not mean?

Leader. It guards us from telling someone they are sealed with no faith in Christ. It does not mean the Spirit was idle before they believed. Do not build a minute-by-minute chart. Do say: the seal belongs to believers.

4. A seal breaks only if someone stronger than the one who set it breaks it. Read John 10:28–29 beside the wax. Who would have to be overpowered for a believer to be unsealed? **CORE**

Leader. The Father, who is greater than all. No one snatches them out of His hand. Jesus came to die, and He keeps His own. Our grip is not the seal.

5. A sealed person can still grieve the Spirit. What would grieving Him look like in this group, and what would honoring the seal look like?

Leader. Lying, contempt, impurity, using people. Ephesians 4:25–32 sits next to the verse. Honoring the seal is obedience to the Word. The Spirit does not guide us by a private impression that excuses sin. We follow the Spirit, not our feelings.

5 • SAY IT • 5 MIN

In one sentence

Sealing means the Holy Spirit marks believers as God's own and guarantees He will bring them to the end.

Ask for two volunteers, not the whole circle. They may look at the sentence, then try it without looking. Clumsy and true is the goal.

6 • THIS WEEK • 5 MIN

Missional challenge

Before next week, carry this word to someone far from Jesus — a neighbor, a classmate, a coworker, a friend. Do it with a real action and with a true sentence. Name the person before you pray.

Show up again for someone far from Jesus whose life will not hold still. Serve them in one plain way. Tell them that when Christ saves a person, God marks them as His and guarantees the end.

Leader. Consistency is the sermon. Do not tell them they are already sealed if they have not believed. The sentence is about what Christ does for those who trust Him. Next week, before the icebreaker, take one minute. Who went, and what happened? One sentence. No speeches.

7 · PRAY · 8 MIN

Pray these, and leave room for others

1. Thank the Father for sealing believers with the Spirit when they believed the gospel.
2. Confess a way we have grieved Him and treated the mark as permission to sin.
3. Pray for someone who fears they have undone their salvation. Point them to Christ, not to a mood.

Before you stumble

Do not say “once saved, always saved” as if sin does not matter. Say what the text says: God seals believers for the day of redemption, and He commands them not to grieve the Spirit. Open rebellion that uses the seal as a shield needs Ephesians 4, not a soft word. A tender believer who is afraid needs John 10:28–29. Know which person you are speaking to. And do not tell an unbeliever in the room that they are already sealed. The seal follows the gospel believed.

WITH STUDENTS

A school stamp can be ignored. A king’s seal cannot. Ask which one God is like in this text, and what the day of redemption is the day He has promised.

IF YOU STILL HAVE TIME

Romans 8:9 and 8:15–16. If anyone does not have the Spirit of Christ, he does not belong to Him. The Spirit bears witness, with the Word, that believers are children. Adoption is next. Do not chase an inner voice.

